

RYAN CALACSAN

Full-Stack Engineer

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Front-end focused full-stack engineer with 5+ years building production React, Next.js, and TypeScript applications, plus 15+ years as a working photographer that informs a real design sensibility. Comfortable owning the full front-end surface, from component architecture and motion to accessibility and performance, and the systems behind it. Solo-built a 200,000+ line production platform at PrintNinja spanning the front end and the backend. Commercial and editorial photography for national outdoor brands, with work published in print.

SKILLS

Front-End: React, Next.js, TypeScript, JavaScript, HTML5, CSS3, SCSS, BEM, Tailwind CSS, Framer Motion, shadcn/ui, Responsive Design, Server-Side Rendering

Design & Accessibility: WCAG 2.2, semantic HTML, ARIA, keyboard navigation, color contrast, Lighthouse audits, component-driven UI, motion / micro-interactions

Backend & APIs: Node.js, Python, FastAPI, PostgreSQL, Drizzle ORM, Payload CMS, REST APIs, Webhooks, LLM APIs (Claude, Gemini)

Tooling & Workflow: Git, GitHub Actions, CI/CD, Docker, Vercel, Cursor, Claude Code, Vitest, Playwright (TDD / E2E)

EXPERIENCE

Principal Engineer | PrintNinja | Aug 2025 – Jan 2026

- Solo-built a 200,000+ line full-stack platform in Next.js, React, and TypeScript with fully responsive, production UI serving customers at printninja.com
- Cut pricing calculation time from 11.47s to under 100ms (100x) through a custom LRU caching strategy
- Migrated a legacy PHP pricing engine (500+ variables, 4 product lines) to TypeScript with 100% mathematical parity, verified by 80+ automated tests
- Integrated Stripe payment processing with webhook idempotency and Salesforce CRM sync across 80+ field mappings
- Wrote 290+ documentation files translating technical systems for non-technical stakeholders; deployed a 12-service Docker stack with zero-downtime releases and scripted rollback

Front End Developer | PrintNinja | Mar 2025 – Aug 2025

- Hired as the company's first in-house engineer to modernize a web platform built on years of contractor debt with no version control
- Audited legacy systems across the stack and CRM, built the modernization roadmap, and led implementation; promoted to Principal Engineer within 5 months

Freelance Web Developer | Self-Employed | 2020 – 2025

- Built responsive marketing sites and web apps for small businesses and community organizations using React, Next.js, JavaScript, and modern CSS

Studio Manager | KH Photography | 2015 – 2019

- Ran studio operations, client creative consultations, and digital asset management across high-volume commercial production

SELECTED PROJECTS

QuoteCraft — Full-stack quote builder with Stripe payments and PDF export. 181 unit + 30 e2e tests. Next.js, TypeScript, Supabase.

OutreachAI — LLM app with live token streaming over Claude + Gemini; dual TypeScript and Python/FastAPI backends. 191 tests, Dockerized.

Chicago Current — Immersive, scroll-driven photo essay built around original photography. Framer Motion + Lenis, responsive parallax animation. Next.js, TypeScript.

Minimal Motion — Typography-focused experience exploring variable fonts, micro-interactions, and CSS animation.

print-check-cli — Published npm package for validating print-ready PDFs. 8 automated checks. Node.js, TypeScript.

LEADERSHIP & COMMUNITY

Co-Founder & Photographer | Outdoor Color Crew | 2024 – Present

- Co-founded and help lead an outdoor-focused affinity group building inclusive experiences for communities of color; organize and lead meetups spanning climbing, biking, hiking, and community socials
- Built and maintain the organization's website, grew the community across Discord and social media, and secured partnerships with outdoor brands and fellow affinity groups

VISUAL & CREATIVE WORK

- Photographed and collaborated with outdoor brands including Arc'teryx, Mountain Hardwear, Osprey, and Hest
- Consulted on a review panel for Mountain Hardwear's Open Aperture Program
- Editorial photography published in Mountain Gazette and Trails Magazine

EDUCATION

B.S. Biology | University of Illinois at Chicago

Frontend Developer Career Path | Scrimba (partnered with MDN)